COMMUNICATION AND HEALTH EDUCATION

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INTENDED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ILOS)

- **By the end of the lecture the student will be able to:**
  - **Define health education**
  - **Identify objectives and key areas of health education.**
  - **Explain communication components and methods used in health education.**
  - **Discuss advantages and limitations of personal, mass, and community approaches.**

DEFINITION OF HEALTH EDUCATION

- Teaching process providing knowledge and promoting healthy behaviors.
- 1977 US Preventive Medicine Conference definition:
  - health education is a process that informs, motivates and helps people to adopt and maintain healthy practices and lifestyles, advocate environmental changes as needed to facilitate this goal and conducts professional training and research to the some end"

OBJECTIVES OF HEALTH EDUCATION

- **Promote healthy lifestyles** (nutrition, exercise, smoking cessation).
- **Prevent disease** through awareness of risk factors and screening.
- **Improve self-care in chronic conditions** (diabetes, hypertension, asthma).
- **Enhance compliance** with treatment and follow-up.
- **Empower families** to take responsibility for their health.
- **Support community health goals** (vaccination, maternal-child health, environmental safety).

KEY AREAS IN FAMILY MEDICINE

- **Lifestyle modification:** Diet, exercise, alcohol, smoking.
- **Chronic disease management:** Diabetes, hypertension, asthma, COPD.
- **Maternal & child health**: Antenatal care, breastfeeding, immunization.
- **Mental health**: Stress management, suicide prevention, resilience building.
- **Accident prevention:** Road safety, home safety, occupational health.
- **Environmental health:** Clean water, sanitation, pollution awareness

COMPONENTS OF HEALTH EDUCATION

- **Communicator (educator or sender):**
  - **who is the originator of the message.**
  - **A variety of personnel can give health education e.g. personal of health services, medical students, nurses, social worker, school personnel and community leaders.**
- **Message:**
  - **which must be in line with objectives, specific, precise clear, understandable and attract attention and interest of recipient.**

- **Recipients (audience):**
  - **the consumers of the messages may be individual, group or total population.**
  - **For effective approach the educator must known personal and social characteristics of the recipients, attitude of recipient towards the message of education**
- **Channels of communication (Methods),**
  - **which must be carefully, selected particularly its cost and availability.**

FUNCTIONS OF COMMUNICATION

- **Establishes relationships** between the persons involved in the communication act.
- **Imports new information** and reinforces a person's knowledge
- **Direct the receiver** in some way to change behavior, stimulate thought, provoke questions, entertain, reinforce attitude, change attitude.
- **Make the receiver adopt the idea** as port of his regular behavior

COMMUNICATION BARRIERS

- **Social and culture gap** between communicator and participants.
- **Limited receptiveness of participants**.
- **Negative attitudes** to communication.
- **Contradictory messages**
- **Insufficient emphasis** on education by the health professional.

PRACTICE (METHOD OF HEALTH EDUCATION):

(1) Personal approach:

- Face to face education or education through spoken word.
- Both the educator and sender are found together, with the same place for talk and discussion.
- Include
  - Individual & family education
  - Group education methods

A- Individual and family education:

- Health education may be given in personal interviews.
- The topics for health counseling may be selected according to the relevance of situation.
- Health education may be given in:
  - 1– Health appraisal (comprehensive medical exam, providing clinical services and screening tests).
    - * In prenatal visit.
    - * Target mother for family planning.
    - * Out reach program.
    - *Dots in case of TB.
  - 2– Home visits by nurse, health work and social worker

B– GROUP HEALTH EDUCATION:

it is an effective way of educating the community.

The choice of the subject must relate directly to the interest of the group.

- **Lessons and lectures.**
- **Seminars** (group discussions), which is a two-way communications.
- **Panel discussions:** group of 4-8 persons talk about the topic and discuss it in front of a group of audience.
- **Symposium**, which is a series of speeches on a selected subject
- **Workshop** used in case of a novel experiment in education.
- **Role-playing**, the group members who enact their roles as they have observed or experienced them.
- **Practical demonstration** e.g. how to prepare ORS.
- **Simulation exercises.**

ADVANTAGES OF PERSONAL APPROACH

- 1- **More effective and impressive:** educator directly faces the recipients.
- 2- **Recipients participate in discussion** (inter action between send & recipient)
- 3- **Valuable to discuss confidential matters** or problems e.g. family planning and birth control.
- 4- **Personal approach can influence KAP** (Knowledge, attitude and practice) of recipients.

DISADVANTAGES OF PERSONAL APPROACH

- **It reaches a limited number of individuals, families, or confined groups.**

MASS COMMUNICATION

- The people are communicated for message of health education by different mass media e.g.
  - broadcasting (radio and T.V.),
  - written word (press as newspaper and magazines, booklets and pamphlets),
  - cinema and theater, teaching aids (slides, film strips and scientific films) and
  - posters.
- It is used for indirect teaching of certain topics and constant keeping them in the public eye e.g. avoidance of accidents and boosting immunization.

MASS COMMUNICATION

- Mass media can be classified into:

  - Visual media: written words and posters.
  - Auditory media: radio broadcasting.
  - Audiovisual media. TV and cinema.

ADVANTAGES OF MASS COMMUNICATION

- 1- Reach millions of people everywhere in no time.
- 2- Suitable to provide knowledge and information, and discuss national health problems as, diarrheal diseases, malnutrition, drug abuse and drug dependence.

DISADVANTAGES OF MASS COMMUNICATION

- **No Feed back** from the recipient. It gives knowledge and instruction only.
- **Not necessarily influence and change attitude, practice and behavior** of exposed recipients.

COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION

- Community non-governmental organizations (NGOS), leaders and influential groups participate in delivery of health services, especially primary health care.
- Health education is a particularly valuable function.

USE OF CAMPAIGNS:

- **Used for special aims** e.g. use of safety belts in cars.
- **Shock tactics** for serious topics e.g. demonstration of damaged cars exhibited beside main roads remind travelers about the result of road accidents.

Thank you